Quick Start — How do I report a bug, an issue, or a task?

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-07-14T21:50:00Z **Authority:** constitution §11.4.202 (reporting directives) + §11.4.140 (action-prefix grammar) **Maintainer:** constitution submodule **Scope:** the one-page version. Full detail: USER_GUIDE.md · REFERENCE.md

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The three commands

Type one of these as the **first line** of your prompt, then just describe the problem in plain language:

```
BUG:   subtitles render one frame late on the secondary display
TASK:  bump the pandoc pin to 3.2 and regenerate the exports
ISSUE: playback stutters on 4K HDR after ~40 minutes — not sure if bug or feature gap
```

Use	When
`BUG:`	Something is **broken** — a regression, a defect, wrong behaviour a user can see.
`TASK:`	Internal **workstream** — refactor, doc, infra, gate, audit, chore.
`ISSUE:`	**Anything trackable** when you have not decided which of the two it is.

Equivalent forms, if you prefer them: `BUG :: …`, `BUG ---> …`, `/helix:bug …`, `/default-bug …`. (Bare `/bug` is **Claude Code's own built-in** — use `BUG:` or `/helix:bug` instead.) `/task …` and `/issue …` work directly.

What makes a good report

You do not need a template — write it as you would to a colleague. Include what you know; the agent records anything you did not say as an explicit `UNKNOWN:` gap rather than inventing it.

- **What** happens, and what you expected instead.
- **Where** — which app / device / screen / build.
- **How to reproduce** it, if you know.
- **How you would know it is fixed** (the acceptance condition).

What the system does with it

1. **Creates a real, tracked workable item** — never a prose "yes, I'll look into it". Status `Queued`, a stable auto-incremented ticket id, the correct Type (`Bug` / `Feature` / `Task` — there is no fourth type), and a structured description (what / scope / reproduction / acceptance).
2. **Regenerates every derived document** from the workable-items database — the open and closed trackers, their summaries, and their `.md` / `.html` / `.pdf` / `.docx` siblings. Nothing is left stale.
3. **Pushes it to every configured external tracker.**
4. For `ISSUE`, if your text does not make the type obvious, **it asks you first** rather than guessing.
5. For `BUG`, if the defect is actionable now, it then **investigates the root cause before proposing any fix**.

What it reports back to you

- the **assigned ticket id**;
- the **sync verdict** (which documents were regenerated);
- **each tracker's verdict**, with the path to the captured evidence.

A tracker whose credentials or client are missing is reported as an honest **SKIP with the reason** (naming only the unset variable, never a value). A push is **never faked** and its absence is **never hidden** — if a tracker was skipped, you will be told.

The guarantee

A report that is only acknowledged is a lost requirement. Every report becomes a real tracked item, or it is explicitly and honestly refused. Nothing evaporates.